Friday, November 17

Under American pressure, Israel's war cabinet has permitted a daily supply of fuel for Gaza, which has unleashed anger among the most extreme members of the coalition. I have the feeling that the government does not have any clear idea how to pursue the operations, how to rescue the hostages, how to keep some American and some west European goodwill despite the increasing chaos and misery in Gaza, how to fend off growing international hostility … Mainly, Israel does not seem to have any plan regarding the fate of Gaza after the war. To declare that it wants to keep control of the security in the enclave is no plan. What governing authority is foreseen for Gaza? None? In the meantime, the settlers are let loose in the West Bank. Apart from giving interviews to American networks, Netanyahu doesn't give a lead anywhere. As the head of the opposition Lapid demanded a few days ago, Netanyahu should go.

The US has warned Israel that without an exit plan from Gaza after the war, the IDF will face the long guerrilla warfare that Americans faced in Iraq and Afghanistan. Both the US and moderate Arab states certainly do not want Hamas to remain in charge, but the only solution they have is a Palestinian Authority government within the context of a two-state solution that Israel—at least under the present government—rejects.

The *New York Times* and the *Guardian* both express doubts today about the evidence provided by the IDF regarding Hamas's military activity at Al-Shifa Hospital. Apart from the corpse of Yehudit Weiss, which was found near the hospital, and the weapons and uniforms that supposedly belonged to Hamas fighters, the IDF uncovered a shaft with steps leading down to tunnels that could not yet be explored because of the danger of booby traps. Only such hard evidence would justify the Israeli incursion into the hospital with its thousands of patients and refugees.